government agency has made any effort to do so. What concerns police and intelligence officials more is the possibility of Lashkar-e-Taiba and Tehreek-ul-Mujahideen militants relying on Ahl-e-Hadith members to provide them safehouses.[53] Indoctrinated Wahhabis, funded from across the border, are unlikely to bite the hand that feeds them. In fact, in south Kashmir, local Wahhabi mosques are recruiting grounds for stone pelters and militants.[54]

So far, under the principle of freedom and equality of religious beliefs, the Government of India has not interfered in the rapid Wahhabisation of the state.[55] The fig leaf of religious freedom enshrined in the Constitution of India has enabled the ISI to exploit it to the hilt and set in place a process that not only challenges the syncretic nature of India but also ruptures the ties that bind the state to the larger country of India. Simultaneously, in collaboration with China, the ISI has tested India's resolve to an extreme in its quest to sequester from and deny India its legal right to exploit 19.48 per cent of the water from the Jhelum, Chenab and Indus rivers.[56]

The problem in Kashmir is not one of granting more or less autonomy to the political leadership of the state; the problem is to protect the encroachment of the state's natural resources, its territory and, by extension, the sovereignty of the Indian nation. The British, when they ruled India, realised this and for the first time in 1889 took charge of the state directly by dispossessing the then ruler. In the succeeding years and centuries, the Government of India has followed the pattern of the intervention of central rule in the state, just as the British did. However, the British never faced the onslaught of Wahhabisation and their resolve was steadfast. The Government of India has so far shown its resolve by combating the combined sabotage of the Kishenganga project by the ISI-China syndicate. However, its responses to the combined Sino-Pak pincer have been diffident.

India has a nuclear triad in place and if it decides to dig into its heels, there is only so much that Sino-Pak forces can pressure it to do. India has allowed China to lock her into a continuously unfavourable balance of